

The Course Journal and Practical Toolkit

When Your Mind Won't Rest

A Christian Course for Overthinking, Worry, Fear, and Renewing Your Mind

Pastor Richmond Kobe · Faithful Path Community

Every worksheet from the book, under its printed name and number, with the course's orientation pages. Print the pages you need; you are not expected to complete them all.

How to use this toolkit

Read this page once, before the worksheets.

The numbers are the book's numbers. Every worksheet keeps the name and number it has in the printed book, so the course, the book and the leaders' guidance always agree. The sections below are the course's arrangement; the cross-reference table on the next page shows where each numbered worksheet now sits.

Do each exercise once for one matter, and then stop. If you find yourself redoing a worksheet to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again.

You do not have to complete every worksheet. Some are optional, and "not today" is a legitimate answer.

Stop any exercise that increases your distress.

Do not begin a full worksheet in the middle of the night. Use only the Night-Time Thought Download (worksheet 25) and return in the day.

If a qualified professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority over anything here, including the exercises and their limits.

Never start, stop or change medication because of anything in this course.

None of these worksheets treats an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma. If you cannot keep yourself safe, do not use a worksheet: use Finding Help Where You Live, and contact emergency or urgent crisis services if you may act on thoughts of harming yourself.

Two worksheets stay out of any group. "If This Happened, What Would It Mean to Me?" (4) and The Faithful Decision Sheet (18) are private. You may say that you used them. Nobody should ask what is on them.

Contents

Section, worksheet number and name.

Begin Here

Before the worksheets: your intention, the boundaries that govern every page, and the page to use if you need more than this course.

—	Before You Begin: A Personal Intention	<i>Start Here</i>
—	Three Boundaries to Acknowledge	<i>Start Here</i>
21	Overthinking Reflection	<i>general</i>
28	When I Need Additional Help	<i>Day 29 of the journey · private</i>

Notice What Is Happening

Seeing what the mind has actually been doing, before anything is tested or released. Lessons 1–5.

1	What Has Been Occupying My Mind?	<i>Lesson 1</i>
2	Healthy Thinking or Mental Circling?	<i>Lesson 2</i>
3	What Have I Been Telling Myself About My Faith?	<i>Lesson 3</i>
4	“If This Happened, What Would It Mean to Me?”	<i>Lesson 4 · NOT FOR GROUP SHARING</i>
5	Body and Mind Check-In	<i>Lesson 5</i>
22	Common Triggers	<i>Day 6 of the journey</i>

Recognise the Pattern

The particular shapes a restless mind takes. Lessons 6–12.

6	Possibility, Probability and Present Reality	<i>Lesson 6</i>
7	Repair, Learn, Continue or Release?	<i>Lesson 7</i>
8	What Was Said and What Did I Imagine?	<i>Lesson 8</i>
9	Facts, Assumptions and Other Possible Explanations	<i>Lesson 9</i>
10	Do I Need More Information or More Courage?	<i>Lesson 10</i>
11	Faithful, Wise or Perfect?	<i>Lesson 11</i>
12	What Is Mine to Carry?	<i>Lesson 12</i>
23	The Worry-Cycle Map	<i>Module 2 pause</i>

Test What the Mind Is Claiming

Examining the claims, and choosing what deserves attention. Lessons 13–15.

13	The Thought-Capturing Record	<i>Lesson 13</i>
14	From False Reassurance to Biblical Truth	<i>Lesson 14</i>
15	The Philippians 4:8 Pastoral Attention Test	<i>Lesson 15</i>

Pray and Release

Prayer that comes to rest, and giving tomorrow back. Lessons 16–17.

16	The Six-Movement Prayer	Lesson 16
17	Today, Later or Release?	Lesson 17
24	Control, Influence or Surrender	general

Make Faithful Decisions

When discernment is finished, and what you are waiting to know. Lessons 18–19.

18	The Faithful Decision Sheet	Lesson 18 · PRIVATE, NOT FOR GROUP SHARING
19	What Am I Waiting to Know Before I Permit Myself to Rest?	Lesson 19

Build a Quieter Rhythm

A rule of life, the boundaries that protect it, and the people who hold it. Lesson 20.

20	My Peace-Supporting Weekly Rhythm	Lesson 20
26	Personal Digital Boundary	Lesson 20
27	Support Map	Lesson 20

For the Night

The one page for the middle of the night. Nothing else until morning.

25	Night-Time Thought Download	general, for the night
----	-----------------------------	------------------------

The 30-Day Mind-Renewal Journey

The thirty day pages as published, and the optional tracker. Each day is marked Worksheet, Brief, Action, Ordinary or Rest.

—	The Thirty Days	Days 1–30
29	30-Day Tracker	the 30-day journey · optional

Emergency and Support Pages

Keep these two pages where you can find them. They are the most important pages in this toolkit.

—	Get Help Now	any time
—	When This Course Is Not Enough (short form)	any time

Cross-reference

Book worksheet number · course section · where it is used. Nothing has been renumbered.

No.	Worksheet	Course section	Used at
1	What Has Been Occupying My Mind?	Notice What Is Happening	Lesson 1
2	Healthy Thinking or Mental Circling?	Notice What Is Happening	Lesson 2
3	What Have I Been Telling Myself About My Faith?	Notice What Is Happening	Lesson 3
4	“If This Happened, What Would It Mean to Me?”	Notice What Is Happening	Lesson 4
5	Body and Mind Check-In	Notice What Is Happening	Lesson 5
6	Possibility, Probability and Present Reality	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 6
7	Repair, Learn, Continue or Release?	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 7
8	What Was Said and What Did I Imagine?	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 8
9	Facts, Assumptions and Other Possible Explanations	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 9
10	Do I Need More Information or More Courage?	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 10
11	Faithful, Wise or Perfect?	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 11
12	What Is Mine to Carry?	Recognise the Pattern	Lesson 12
13	The Thought-Capturing Record	Test What the Mind Is Claiming	Lesson 13
14	From False Reassurance to Biblical Truth	Test What the Mind Is Claiming	Lesson 14
15	The Philippians 4:8 Pastoral Attention Test	Test What the Mind Is Claiming	Lesson 15
16	The Six-Movement Prayer	Pray and Release	Lesson 16
17	Today, Later or Release?	Pray and Release	Lesson 17
18	The Faithful Decision Sheet	Make Faithful Decisions	Lesson 18
19	What Am I Waiting to Know Before I Permit Myself to Rest?	Make Faithful Decisions	Lesson 19
20	My Peace-Supporting Weekly Rhythm	Build a Quieter Rhythm	Lesson 20
21	Overthinking Reflection	Begin Here	general
22	Common Triggers	Notice What Is Happening	Day 6 of the journey
23	The Worry-Cycle Map	Recognise the Pattern	Module 2 pause
24	Control, Influence or Surrender	Pray and Release	general
25	Night-Time Thought Download	For the Night	general, for the night
26	Personal Digital Boundary	Build a Quieter Rhythm	Lesson 20
27	Support Map	Build a Quieter Rhythm	Lesson 20
28	When I Need Additional Help	Begin Here	Day 29 of the journey · private
29	30-Day Tracker	The 30-Day Mind-Renewal Journey	the 30-day journey · optional

Begin Here

Before the worksheets: your intention, the boundaries that govern every page, and the page to use if you need more than this course.

Before You Begin: A Personal Intention

Course orientation page · [Start Here](#)

Two questions, and only two. If you wish, answer them in a sentence or two each, in your own words. There is nothing to rate and nothing to get right. You may answer either question, both questions or neither.

What brought you to this course?

What would you like to understand or practise?

On the site these answers are saved in your private journal so that you can read them again at the end of the course. Your answers are private and are not monitored. Writing that you need help does not alert Faithful Path or contact a support service.

Three Boundaries to Acknowledge

Course orientation page from "When This Course Is Not Enough"

Please read and acknowledge these three boundaries before continuing with the foundation journey. They protect the purpose of the course and remind you where additional help is available.

- I understand this is pastoral formation, not medical or psychological treatment.
- I know where to find "When This Course Is Not Enough".
- I understand I can stop or skip any exercise.

On the site, the course records only whether each statement has been checked and the acknowledgement date. The boxes are not a safety assessment, consent to treatment or a waiver of any right. Ticking them does not tell Faithful Path that you are safe, and it does not contact help. Nothing in the course is locked.

Overthinking Reflection

Worksheet 21 · general

Not a self-assessment, and not scored. For an honest look at where the restless mind shows up most. Answer in words, not numbers.

When my mind will not rest, it most often goes to (the future / the past / conversations / other people's thoughts / decisions / my own faults / the people I carry):

The times and places it happens most:

What it costs me (sleep, presence, work, relationships, worship):

Which lessons of this course named my pattern most clearly:

Which two or three worksheets I would reach for first:

Whether anything in the help notes spoke to me, and what I will do about it:

When I Need Additional Help

Worksheet 28 · Day 29 of the journey · private

Private. An honest page. Completing it is not a failure; for some members it is what the course was for. Your answers are not monitored, and writing that you need help does not alert Faithful Path or contact a support service — if you need a person, use Finding Help Where You Live.

Recently, has my worry or low mood been severe, persistent, rapidly worsening, or interfering with sleep, work, relationships or daily functioning?

Have any of the help notes in this course described me?

Have any of the practices become compulsory, produced significant distress, or felt impossible to stop?

Who will I contact, and when?

If you cannot keep yourself safe, do not wait for a routine appointment. Use Finding Help Where You Live now, and contact emergency or urgent crisis services if you may act on thoughts of harming yourself.

Notice What Is Happening

Seeing what the mind has actually been doing, before anything is tested or released. Lessons 1–5.

What Has Been Occupying My Mind?

Worksheet 1 · Lesson 1

Most overthinkers have never written down what occupies their mind. They have only experienced it as a blur of pressure. Writing it down does three things. It slows the thoughts to the speed of your hand. It moves them from inside your head to outside, where they can be looked at. And it usually reveals that the crowd of worries is smaller and more repetitive than it felt.

Do not try to fix anything as you write. Do not argue with the thoughts or pray them away yet. Just notice.

This exercise works best over three to five days. Complete it during the day; if it is the middle of the night, use only the Night-Time Thought Download and return to this page tomorrow.

Step 1. Empty the room. Write down everything your mind has been returning to over the past week. Do not organise it. Do not judge it. Big things and small things go on the same list. A conversation, a bill, a decision, a health worry, a person, a regret, a fear about the future. Keep writing until nothing else comes.

Step 2. Mark the repeat visitors. Go back through the list and put a mark beside anything you have thought about more than three times this week. These are your repeat visitors. Many people discover that a relatively small number of concerns have been returning repeatedly.

Step 3. Describe each repeat visitor. For each one, answer briefly:

What exactly am I thinking about when this comes up?

Is there a question my mind keeps asking?

What would I need to know, or have settled, for this thought to stop?

Step 4. Notice the pattern. Looking across your repeat visitors, what do they have in common? Are they mostly about the past or the future? About other people's opinions? About decisions? About money, health, or relationships? Write one sentence that describes what your mind seems to be trying to protect you from.

Step 5. Bring the list to God. Read your list aloud to him, slowly, item by item. You are not asking for anything yet. You are simply showing him what is in the room. Then read Psalm 94:19 once more.

Keep this page. You will return to it in Chapters 2 and 4.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Healthy Thinking or Mental Circling?

Worksheet 2 · Lesson 2

Before you begin. Choose one recurring subject and complete a maximum of one brief entry per day, over no more than three days. Do not record every recurrence, and do not begin a new copy for the same subject because uncertainty returns. Use it during the day; if the thought returns at night, use only the Night-Time Thought Download.

For the next three days, carry the five questions with you. Each time you notice your mind returning to a subject for the third time or more, stop and complete one entry.

The subject. In one line, what was I thinking about?

The kind. Which of the seven best describes it? (Reflection / Planning / Discernment / Problem-solving / Worry / Rumination / Obsessive thinking)

The five questions. Answer yes or no, and add one short note if it helps.

Is this producing a clear action?

Am I learning anything new?

Is this within my control?

Have I already considered this? Is continued thinking helping me obey God?

The verdict. Healthy thinking that has not finished, or mental circling?

If circling, what now? Choose one: Act. Wait. Seek help. Surrender. Write one sentence about what that would look like today.

If you find yourself repeating this exercise on the same thought in search of perfect reassurance, stop. Complete it no more than once for that thought during the day. Repeatedly checking your answer can become part of the cycle rather than a way out of it.

After three days, read your entries together. Notice which subjects appeared most often, which kind of unhealthy thinking dominates, and how often the honest answer to “Am I learning anything new?” was no. Keep this record. Lesson 4 will ask what fear sits beneath the subjects that kept returning.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

What Have I Been Telling Myself About My Faith?

Worksheet 3 · Lesson 3

Before you begin. This worksheet is not an assessment of whether you have genuine faith, and completing it does not affect your standing with God. Complete it once, during the day; do not use it at night, and do not repeat it to obtain assurance. Persistent or disabling anxiety may need professional assessment.

This exercise works with the shaming sentences directly. Complete it once, carefully, rather than repeatedly.

Step 1. Write the sentences. List the things you have told yourself about your faith because of your anxiety. Write them exactly as they sound in your head, however harsh. Aim for three to six.

Step 2. Trace each one. Beside each sentence, note where it came from as best you can: a sermon, a book, a family member, a comparison with others, or simply your own conclusion.

Step 3. Sort each one. Ask which of the four the sentence is really about: a feeling, a physical reaction, an unwanted thought, or a chosen response. Most shaming sentences judge a feeling or a bodily reaction as though it were a chosen response.

Step 4. Test it against Scripture. For each sentence, write one thing God has actually said that addresses it. Use Psalm 56:3–4, 1 Peter 5:7, Romans 8:1, or another passage you know. Do not search for the perfect verse. One honest verse is enough.

Step 5. Rewrite it. Turn each shaming sentence into a truthful one. For example:

“If I trusted God, I would not feel this way.” → “I feel afraid, and I am choosing to trust God with it.”

“I should be able to pray this away.” → “Prayer is where I bring this, not a switch that removes it.”

Step 6. Choose one to keep. Select one rewritten sentence and carry it with you this week. Say it to yourself whenever the old sentence appears.

If you notice that you are returning to this exercise to make sure you have “got it right,” or to reassure yourself again about your standing with God, stop. Complete it once. Your standing with God does not depend on completing the worksheet correctly.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

“If This Happened, What Would It Mean to Me?”

Worksheet 4 · Lesson 4 · NOT FOR GROUP SHARING

NOT FOR GROUP SHARING. This exercise is optional and private. You are not required to disclose your answers to a group leader, pastor, spouse or other participant. It is not a method for recovering memories, and whatever comes to mind is not a message from God or a definitive explanation. Ask the downward question no more than three times, and stop earlier if nothing comes or discomfort rises. “No deeper fear appeared” is a complete result. Do not use it with trauma memories, do not use it in the middle of the night, and do not repeat it to find a deeper answer. Present danger requires safety action, not deeper interpretation.

Stop the exercise if you become overwhelmed, disconnected from your surroundings, panicked or unable to return your attention to the present. Put the page aside, notice where you are, contact someone safe and seek appropriate professional support. You do not need to uncover the deepest explanation today.

Choose one repeat visitor—the thought that has returned most often. Complete this exercise once for that thought, and then stop. Do not repeat it on the same thought looking for a better answer.

Step 1. Begin with prayer. Read Psalm 139:23–24 and ask God for honesty, wisdom and gentleness as you consider whether the surface concern carries a deeper meaning.

Step 2. Write the surface thought. In one line, what is the thought about? (Samuel: The elders will not be happy with the budget.)

Step 3. Note the practical action. What reasonable action, if any, does the surface problem still require of you? Write it down so it is not lost. It will need its own attention.

Step 4. Ask the question and write the answer. If this happened, what would it mean to me?

Step 5. Ask it again, of your answer. And if that were true, what would it mean to me?

Step 6. Ask again, until the sentence changes. Keep going, no more than five times, until the sentence is no longer about the situation and is about you, your worth, your safety, your future, or God. If no deeper sentence appears, that is a legitimate result. The surface problem may be the whole issue.

Step 7. Name the fear, if there is one. Look at the list of common fears. Which one is this closest to? Write it in your own words: I am afraid that...

Step 8. Notice any known connection. (Optional.) Does this fear remind you of a situation or relationship you already remember? If so, note it briefly. If not, leave this step blank. You do not need to discover where a fear began before you can respond to it wisely.

Step 9. Bring it to God as it is. Write a one-line prayer that names the fear directly. Not only Help me with the budget, but Father, I am afraid of being set aside.

Step 10. Decide who else should know. Name one person who could hear this fear from you. If the fear feels too heavy to carry with a friend, that is a sign to speak with a pastor or counsellor.

Keep this page. Module 3 will return to the fear you have named and show you how to test it against the truth.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Body and Mind Check-In

Worksheet 5 · Lesson 5

Urgent physical symptoms. Do not assume that chest pain, severe difficulty breathing, fainting, sudden confusion or another new or severe physical symptom is anxiety. Seek urgent medical assessment or contact your local emergency services. This check-in is not a symptom checker and must not delay medical care. Complete Parts One to Four during the day, once for the past week. Do not complete the full check-in at night; the six-question short version may be used then if it does not increase alertness.

These questions do not diagnose the cause. They help you decide whether to rest, take a practical step, contact a healthcare professional or seek urgent support. If you cannot keep yourself safe, close this page and use Finding Help Where You Live now.

Complete this once for the past week, and then use the short version whenever your mind is racing.

Part One: The past week.

Sleep. Roughly how many hours have I slept each night this week? Has the sleep been restful?

Food and water. Have I eaten regular meals and had enough to drink? Have I skipped meals or eaten mainly whatever was quickest?

Caffeine and other stimulants. What caffeine-containing drinks, supplements or other stimulants have I used, how much and at what time?

Health. Am I unwell, in pain, or recovering from something? Has anything changed in medication I take?

Rest. When was my last full day off? When was my last unhurried hour?

Season. How long has this stretch of pressure lasted? Weeks? Months? Longer?

Part Two: The connection.

Looking at the past week, is there any pattern between the days my body was under most strain and the days my mind was most restless? Write a sentence describing what you notice. If there is no clear connection, write that. Not every restless mind has a physical explanation.

Part Three: One change.

Choose one physical factor you can realistically adjust this week. Not five. One. Write it in a single sentence. (This week I will stop drinking coffee after lunch. This week I will be in bed by eleven on four nights.)

Part Four: What belongs to a doctor.

Is there anything in Part One—persistent sleeplessness, ongoing symptoms, a change in medication, a season of exhaustion that is not lifting—that should be raised with a doctor or other professional? If so, write the name of the person you will contact and when.

The short version.

When your mind is racing, ask six questions:

How have I slept over the past few nights?

Have I eaten regularly and had enough water?

How much caffeine, alcohol, nicotine or other stimulant have I used, and when?

Am I unwell, in pain or experiencing new symptoms?

How long has this pattern lasted?

Is it affecting my safety or ability to function?

These questions do not diagnose the cause. They help you decide whether to rest, take a practical step, contact a healthcare professional or seek urgent support.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Common Triggers

Worksheet 22 · Day 6 of the journey

Tick what applies; add your own. A trigger is a situation or state, not a moral failing.

- Late evening / lying in bed
- An unanswered message or email
- A particular person or relationship
- Hunger, tiredness or illness
- Caffeine or alcohol
- The news, social media or a particular feed
- Sunday night / the start of the working week
- Money conversations or bills
- Medical appointments or results
- A decision that has been waiting
- Silence or an empty afternoon
- Other:

The trigger that is easiest to change, and how:

The trigger that cannot be changed and must be met differently, and with which worksheet:

Recognise the Pattern

The particular shapes a restless mind takes. Lessons 6–12.

Possibility, Probability and Present Reality

Worksheet 6 · Lesson 6

When caution is not catastrophising. If there is evidence of abuse, violence, stalking, coercion, a medical emergency or another immediate danger, do not use this exercise to persuade yourself that the danger is probably imaginary. Move to safety and contact appropriate professional or emergency support. The purpose of testing predictions is to improve judgement, not to silence legitimate warning signs.

Use this exercise for one prediction at a time. Choose something your mind has been forecasting this week. If several come to mind, choose the one that has cost you the most sleep. Please read the box at the top of this page, When caution is not catastrophising, before you begin.

Step 1. Name the trigger.

In one sentence, what actually happened? Describe only the event, not what it means. (My manager asked to see me tomorrow. The test results have not come back yet. My daughter did not answer her phone.)

Step 2. Write out the chain.

Set down, link by link, the sequence of consequences your mind produced, in the order it produced them. Do not tidy it up or make it sound reasonable. Write it exactly as it ran.

Step 3. Take the first link only.

Copy the first link on its own line, beginning “I am predicting that...” This is the only link you will examine. If it does not hold, the rest need not be examined at all.

Step 4. Possible?

Is the first link possible? Answer honestly. Most things are. Write yes or no and move on; this step is here so that you do not mistake possibility for evidence.

Step 5. What evidence supports or challenges it?

Write, on separate lines, what you actually know that supports the prediction, and what you actually know that challenges it. Then write two or three other explanations that could equally account for the trigger.

Now write a single sentence stating your honest judgement: does the evidence make this outcome probable, unlikely, or genuinely unclear? You are not calculating a percentage. If you cannot judge— because the matter is medical, legal, financial or a question of safety —write the name of the qualified person who could help you judge it.

If your honest judgement is that the outcome is probable, write that plainly. It is a legitimate result, and Step 7 will tell you what to do with it.

Step 6. Happening now.

Write one sentence beginning “What is actually true right now is...” Include only what you know.

Step 7. Requiring action now.

Is there a specific, bounded action the present situation asks of you? If so, write it in one sentence and, if possible, do it today. If there is nothing, write “Nothing is required of me today except...” and complete the sentence with the ordinary things of your day.

If the feared outcome is probable, this is where you write your preparation. Write the concrete steps that are reasonably necessary now. Keep them specific and bounded, and distinguish today’s actions from those that

can only be taken later. When today's steps are written, today's preparing is finished.

Step 8. Give tomorrow back.

Read Matthew 6:34 once, slowly. Then write one sentence handing whatever remains to God.

Once is enough. Complete this worksheet once for one prediction, and then stop. If the prediction returns, briefly reread your Step 6 sentence rather than completing the worksheet again. Return to it only if materially new information changes the situation, not merely because the fear has returned or the answer no longer feels reassuring; the aim is honesty, not reassurance. Keep this page. You will use a version of this tool again in Lesson 17, and the Possibility, Probability and Present Reality worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is designed for repeated use.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Repair, Learn, Continue or Release?

Worksheet 7 · Lesson 7

Before you begin. This worksheet is not for trauma memories. Stop if distress or a sense of reliving develops. Make no direct contact where it is unsafe, prohibited or contrary to a safeguarding or legal process. Do not use it in the middle of the night; use only the Night-Time Thought Download and return during the day. Complete it once for one event, and return only when genuinely new information emerges.

Use this exercise for one past event at a time. Choose the one your mind returns to most. Complete it once, carefully, and keep the page.

Stop the exercise if the memory you are working with is of a traumatic event and writing about it produces intense distress, physical symptoms, or a sense of reliving it. This exercise is designed for regrets and mistakes, not for trauma. Close the page, do something grounding and ordinary, and speak with a qualified professional before returning to the memory.

Step 1. Name the event.

In two or three sentences, write what happened. State the facts as plainly as you can, without either excusing or exaggerating your part.

Step 2. Name my part honestly.

Was there sin in what I did? Carelessness? An honest mistake? A reasonable decision with a bad outcome? No fault at all? Write one sentence. If you are genuinely uncertain, consider discussing it once with a pastor or mature Christian who understands both Scripture and scrupulosity. If you have already received a careful answer but continue asking others in search of certainty, the repeated questioning may be part of the cycle.

Step 3. Repair.

Is there a safe and appropriate responsibility that remains—an apology, restitution, a conversation, a practical amend? If yes, write exactly what, to whom, and when you will do it. If the situation involves serious harm, abuse, legal concerns, safeguarding responsibilities or a request for no contact, write instead the name of the person or process you will consult before acting. If repair has already been done, write “Repair has been made,” and note when. If repair is not possible (the person has died, the loss cannot be recovered), write that plainly.

If repair has already been made and accepted, do not plan to repeat it.

Step 4. Learn.

Write, in one or two sentences, what truth or changed practice you intend to carry forward. Be specific. This is the sentence you will show your mind when it wants to run the scene again “so that you remember.”

Step 5. Continue. Is there an ongoing consequence or commitment you must faithfully maintain—a repayment, a boundary, an accountability relationship, a changed pattern of behaviour, a process you have agreed to? Write what it is and how you are keeping it. This belongs to the present, not the replay. If there is nothing ongoing, write “Nothing further is required.”

Step 6. Release.

Write what remains after repair, learning and continuing commitments: the part that cannot be changed. Then, if there was sin, confess it once, in writing or aloud, and write beneath it the words of 1 John 1:9. If there was no sin, write instead one sentence acknowledging that you did not know what you could not know, and that God’s providence is larger than your error. Then write one sentence handing what remains to him.

Step 7. What I will say when it returns.

Write a short sentence, in your own words, that you can say to yourself the next time the replay begins.
(Repair is made, the lesson is written, I am keeping what I promised, and the rest is with God.)

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per event. If the replay returns, use the sentence from Step 7 and turn your attention to the present. Do not redo Step 6 in search of a better feeling; forgiveness does not depend on the feeling. Return to the exercise only if something genuinely new has occurred or come to light. If the replay continues to intrude regularly despite this, speak with your pastor, a counsellor or your doctor. Keep this page. You will return to the Repair, Learn, Continue or Release pattern in Lesson 8, and the toolkit at the back of the book includes a version of it for repeated use.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

What Was Said and What Did I Imagine?

Worksheet 8 · Lesson 8

Before you begin. If the person has been abusive, coercive or unsafe, do not use this worksheet to prepare direct contact. Seek guidance first from a specialist domestic-abuse service, a safeguarding professional or another appropriately qualified professional; the responsible decision may be not to have the conversation at all. Complete this worksheet once for one conversation, during the day; do not use it in the middle of the night, and do not repeatedly rewrite your prepared sentences to make them perfect. If the conversation materially changes you may update the relevant facts; the return of anxiety alone is not a reason to repeat the exercise.

Use this exercise for one rehearsed conversation at a time. Choose the one that has been running most often.

Step 1. The conversation in my head.

Briefly record the main version of the conversation as you have been rehearsing it: no more than ten lines, or five minutes. The purpose is to identify the pattern, not to reproduce every imagined exchange. If writing the dialogue increases distress or creates an urge to perfect it, stop and summarise it in one sentence instead.

Step 2. What was actually said.

Now, on a separate part of the page, write only what this person has actually said to you about this matter, and when. Memory is not a recording. If you are uncertain about the exact words, describe the substance and clearly mark what you do not remember. If you can recall nothing specific, write that. If it was a look, a tone or a silence rather than words, write that honestly too, and note that you are interpreting it.

Step 3. What I imagined.

Go back to Step 1 and mark every line you gave to the other person. For each, ask: did they say this, or did I write it for them? Write one sentence about what you notice. (Everything after her first remark is mine.)

Step 4. Is a real conversation needed?

Answer one of the following, and write one sentence explaining why.

Yes, and I will have it. The matter is real and affects the relationship. Note the time and method that would be appropriate.

Not yet. Something needs to settle first, I need to understand more, or the setting is not right.

No. The matter is small enough to let go, or it is not mine to raise.

I am not sure, and I should ask someone. Write who.

Step 5. My part, prepared once.

If a conversation is needed, write what belongs to you: how you will open, the one thing you most want the other person to understand, and any facts, questions or boundaries the situation genuinely requires. If it helps, note one or two realistic ways the other person might respond, marked clearly as possibilities. Do not write out their side, and do not write your reply to their reply. When this is written, your preparation is finished.

Step 6. How I will hear.

Write one sentence about how you will listen. (I will let her finish. I will ask one question before I answer.)

Step 7. Release the rest.

Write one sentence handing the other person's part, and the outcome, to God.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per conversation. If the rehearsal returns, remind yourself of Step 5 and Step 6 and turn your attention elsewhere. Do not rewrite your sentences repeatedly in search of the perfect wording; a plain, sincere version is enough. Keep this page. You will use the distinction between what was said and what was imagined again in Lesson 9, and the Facts, Assumptions and Other Possible Explanations worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is built on it.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Facts, Assumptions and Other Possible Explanations

Worksheet 9 · Lesson 9

Before you begin. This worksheet is not designed to explain away repeated harm. Asking is optional and only appropriate in a safe relationship, and direct communication does not guarantee truthful disclosure. Complete it once for one person and one situation, during the day; do not use it in the middle of the night.

Use this exercise for one person and one situation at a time. Choose the one that has been occupying you most.

Before you begin. If the person concerned has a pattern of harmful behaviour towards you, this exercise is not asking you to explain that pattern away. Record what you have observed honestly in Step 1; a pattern of observations is itself evidence. Then take the situation to someone qualified rather than trying to generate kinder interpretations of harm.

Step 1. What I have observed.

Write only what was said, done or recorded, without assigning a motive. (He has not replied since the 12th. She left straight after the service.) Where your memory is uncertain, say so. If you find an interpreting word creeping in—ignored, snubbed, cold—cross it out and describe the behaviour instead.

Step 2. My interpretation.

Write, in one sentence, what you have concluded the person thinks or feels. Be honest about how certain you have been feeling.

Step 3. Single event or pattern?

Is what you observed a single event, or has it repeated over time? If it has repeated, briefly note how often and for how long. A single event supports many interpretations; a sustained pattern is stronger evidence and should be taken seriously.

Step 4. Other possible explanations.

Write two or three other plausible accounts that would fit the observations in Step 1 equally well, then stop. Include at least one that has nothing to do with you. You are not being asked to believe them, only to show yourself that they exist. If this step becomes a search for the perfectly reassuring explanation, return to “I do not know” and move on.

Step 5. What I actually know.

Write one sentence beginning “What I actually know is...” and complete it with the observations alone. Then write a second sentence: “What I do not know is...”

Step 6. Ask, wait or let go.

Choose one and write a sentence explaining why.

Ask clearly. Write the question you will ask, keeping it short and free of accusation, and note when you will ask it. Choose this only if the relationship is safe. Reasonable clarification or follow-up may be appropriate when an answer is incomplete or new information emerges.

Wait. Write how you will behave towards the person in the meantime: ordinary respect, neither punishing nor pretending.

Let go. Write what you are setting down.

Step 7. Release.

Write one sentence entrusting the other person's heart, and your own, to the God who searches both.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per situation. If the interpretation returns, reread Step 5 and turn your attention elsewhere. If you chose Ask, do not run the exercise again merely to reduce uncertainty while waiting. Receive the person's answer as evidence. Seek further clarification only when there is a genuine gap, a new fact or a practical reason to continue the conversation, rather than solely to obtain certainty. Keep this page. The Facts, Assumptions and Other Possible Explanations worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is a shorter version of this exercise for repeated use.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Do I Need More Information or More Courage?

Worksheet 10 • Lesson 10

Before you begin. This worksheet does not replace medical, legal, financial or safety advice. Complete it once for one decision, during the day, and not in the middle of the night. Fear returning is not new information. A major decision should not rest solely on an impression, a coincidence or a claimed prophetic word, and no leader may use "God told me" to control another person's decision.

Use this exercise for one decision at a time. Choose the one you have been circling longest.

Step 1. The decision.

Write it in one sentence, as a choice between named options. (Accept the post in the other city, or stay.)

Step 2. How long.

How long have you been discerning this? Is there a real deadline? Write both.

Step 3. The ordinary means.

Answer each briefly.

Scripture. Does God's Word forbid or command either option? If neither, write "This is a choice between permissible things."

Wisdom. What do the practical realities honestly suggest? What consequences and responsibilities does each option carry?

Counsel. Whom have you asked, and what did they say? If you have not asked anyone suitable, name a small, appropriate circle and ask them. If a question needs a professional—medical, legal, financial— name the professional. If you have already received careful answers, write them here and do not keep asking the same question of new people.

Circumstances. What do the facts actually permit or prevent?

Desire. What do you want to do? Write it plainly. Then write one sentence about what that desire might reflect—a gift, a healthy longing, a fear, or something mixed.

Step 4. The signs I have been collecting.

If you have been reading sermons, songs, verses, impressions or coincidences as signs, list them, and note whether they point in one direction or both. Then write one sentence about how much weight they should carry, given the principles in this chapter.

Step 5. What do I need: information, courage, or both?

Write your honest answer to: What information is genuinely missing, and what courage will still be required after I have it? Then mark which of these fits.

I need specific information. Name exactly what is missing, where you will get it, and by when. Return to this step once you have it.

I have sufficient information and need courage. Write what you are afraid of, in one sentence. Then write what you would advise a friend in your position who had all the same answers.

I need both. Do the first, and write the second now, so that you are ready for it.

Step 6. My present faithful response: act, wait for a defined reason, seek qualified help, or surrender.

Choose one, and write a sentence explaining why.

Act. Write what you will do and when.

Wait. Write the specific reason and the date by which the waiting ends.

Seek help. Write whom, about what, and when.

Surrender. Write what is not yours to decide or control, and hand it over.

Step 7. Decide with God.

Write a short prayer, in your own words, telling God what you intend and asking for humility and faithfulness in whatever follows.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per decision. Do not assume that the return of fear means the decision was wrong; fear after a decision is normal. Reconsideration is appropriate when significant new information emerges, circumstances materially change, or a trusted adviser raises a genuine concern—not because the feeling of certainty has not arrived. If you chose Wait and the date comes, return to Step 5 with whatever you now know, and do not extend the wait without a new reason. Keep this page. You will use Act, Wait, Seek Help or Surrender again in Lessons 12, 17 and 18, and the Control, Influence or Surrender worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is built on it.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Faithful, Wise or Perfect?

Worksheet 11 · Lesson 11

Before you begin. If checking feels compulsive, produces severe distress, or is connected to diagnosed or suspected OCD, do not use this worksheet to remove checks or resist compulsions on your own; leave it unused unless the professional supporting you considers it suitable. Do not use it for safety-critical or regulated work. Complete it once for one low-risk task, during the day. Once the work is closed or submitted, do not reopen it solely for reassurance; materially new information, a genuine error report or a required correction may justify review. Nothing here asks you to lower a standard that the task, your profession or someone's safety genuinely sets.

Use this exercise for one task at a time. Choose something you are currently redoing, over-checking or unable to finish. If checking is compulsive or connected to OCD, please read the box earlier in this chapter before using it.

Step 1. The task.

Write what it is, in one sentence, and who it is for.

Step 2. The four standards.

Answer each briefly.

Required. What must this task have to be done safely, ethically and competently? Include any check that your training, profession or process genuinely requires. If unsure, ask a competent colleague and write their answer.

Excellent. What one or two improvements would meaningfully serve the purpose of the work?

Wise. Roughly how much time and attention is proportionate, given the benefit and your other responsibilities?

Perfectionistic. What have you been doing beyond the above? Beside each item, note honestly whether it is required, excellent, wise, or seeking a certainty the task cannot provide.

Step 3. The cost.

Write how long the task should take and how long it has taken or is likely to take. Write what else that time was for.

Step 4. What the fear says.

Write, in a sentence or two, what you are afraid will happen if you stop at the standard in Step 2. Then write what would actually happen if that fear came true, and how you would handle it using Repair, Learn, Continue or Release.

Step 5. The stopping point.

Write, as specifically as you can, the point at which you will stop and release the work. (After the required check and one read for clarity, before 5 p.m., I will send it.) Make a reasonable judgement here and do not try to make it certain.

Step 6. Release.

When you have reached the stopping point, write one sentence handing the work, and its imperfections, to God. Then send, submit or close it.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per task. If the urge to check or redo returns after you have released the work, notice it, name it, and ask whether anything new justifies it. If nothing does, do not act on it. Do not reopen the work to reassure yourself. If you find that you cannot stop despite this, that is information, not failure; speak with a professional. Keep this page. The Faithful, Wise or Perfect worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is a short version for repeated use.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

What Is Mine to Carry?

Worksheet 12 · Lesson 12

Before you begin. Do not stop established care or safeguarding action abruptly. Immediate danger requires appropriate emergency or crisis support. This worksheet does not determine legal or caregiving obligations, and feelings of relief or distress do not decide whose responsibility something is. Complete it during the day, once per person and situation, and do not repeat it solely because worry returns.

Use this exercise for the people currently occupying your mind. You may find it helps to do it for one person at a time, beginning with the heaviest.

Step 1. The list.

Write the names of the people whose difficulties you have been carrying. Beside each, write in a few words what you have been carrying for them.

Step 2. The five questions.

For each name, answer briefly:

Did they ask?

Do I have an established responsibility here?

Is there a serious need they cannot presently address alone?

Am I the appropriate person to respond?

Is the help I have been giving, or am considering, wanted, safe and sustainable?

Step 3. Sort the weight.

For each name, write one of the following, and one sentence explaining why.

Carry. This responsibility properly belongs to my role.

Share. This is too heavy for one person and I can appropriately help, in a specific and bounded way.

Offer. I may offer support, but the other person retains the choice.

Refer. This needs someone more qualified or authorised than me.

Release. I have no appropriate action, or my part is complete.

Be honest in both directions. Do not choose release to escape a duty, and do not choose carry because putting it down feels unbearable.

Step 4. The faithful response.

For each name, choose one and write what it means in practice.

Act. What is mine to carry, share or offer, I will do, today, and no more than today requires. Write what.

Wait. Help may be appropriate but is not yet wanted or timely. Write what I am waiting for.

Seek help. This person needs someone I am not, or the load that is mine is too heavy to carry alone. Write who I will point them to, or whom I will ask.

Surrender. This is not mine, or my part is complete. Write the sentence you will say when the weight returns. (My son's marriage belongs to him, his wife and God. I have offered what was mine to offer.)

Step 5. The load that is mine.

Now write, in a few lines, what actually is yours to carry at the moment: your own conduct, your own decisions, the people who genuinely depend on you. Ask whether any of it has been neglected while you carried the rest. If the load that is yours is genuinely heavy, write what support it needs and whom you will ask.

Step 6. Hand them over.

Read your list aloud, one name at a time, and after each say: I entrust them to you. Then close the page.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per person, and reread Step 4 when the carrying returns rather than redoing the sort. Do not use the return of worry as evidence that you should pick the person back up. If sorting a particular person leaves you distressed rather than lighter, that may mean the load is genuinely heavy, and it is worth talking to someone rather than carrying on alone. Keep this page. The Control, Influence or Surrender worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is a shorter version of this exercise for repeated use, and you will use the four faithful responses again in Lessons 17 and 18.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

The Worry-Cycle Map

Worksheet 23 · Module 2 pause

For seeing the shape of a particular cycle so that it can be interrupted earlier.

The trigger (what started it):

The first thought:

The feeling and the bodily reaction:

What the mind did next (predicted, replayed, rehearsed, read minds, sought certainty, checked, carried someone):

What I did (checked, asked, avoided, stayed up, scrolled, prayed anxiously, withdrew):

Where it ended, and how long it took:

The earliest point at which I could have noticed, and which practice fits there:

Complete this once for one cycle, then stop.

Test What the Mind Is Claiming

Examining the claims, and choosing what deserves attention. Lessons 13–15.

The Thought-Capturing Record

Worksheet 13 · Lesson 13

Before you begin. This record is for thoughts that make a claim you can examine. It is not for intrusive thoughts — sudden, unwanted, distressing thoughts or images — and fighting those usually makes them worse; a qualified professional can advise about appropriate support. Complete it once a day at most, for one thought, during the day. Do not use it to monitor your mind continuously, and do not use it in the middle of the night.

Use this record for one recurring thought at a time, once a day at most. It is for thoughts that make a claim you can examine. It is not for every thought, and it is not for the intrusive thoughts described in the box earlier in this chapter.

Step 1. Notice.

Write the thought as a sentence, as close as you can to the words your mind uses. (I am going to lose this client. She thinks I am useless. God has stopped listening.)

Step 2. Name.

What kind of thought is it? (A prediction. A replay. A rehearsal. Mind-reading. A demand for certainty. A perfectionistic standard. Carrying someone.) If it fits more than one, write them. If it makes no claim—if it is an image, a memory or mental noise—stop here; this record is not the tool for it.

Step 3. Test.

What does the thought claim? Write the claim in one sentence. Then answer briefly: Is it true? Is it the whole truth? Is it consistent with what God has said? What evidence supports it, and what does not?

Step 4. Refuse.

Write, in one sentence, what you will not do because of this thought. (I will not treat the loss of the client as certain. I will not withdraw from her because of what I imagine she thinks.) This does not remove the thought. It removes its authority.

Step 5. Reorient.

Write where your attention will go instead: a relevant truth, a present responsibility, or an ordinary activity. Keep it true rather than merely comforting, and do not search for the perfect sentence.

Step 6. Act.

Write the next faithful thing you will do, today, and when.

Step 7. When it returns.

Write a short sentence you can say to yourself the next time this thought arrives. (Tested this morning. Not certain. Back to the task.)

Once is enough. Complete this record once per thought per day. When the thought returns, reread Step 7 rather than redoing the record. Do not use the record to monitor your mind continuously; if you find yourself doing so, put it away for a day. And if the thoughts you are recording are intrusive in the sense described in the box above, this record is not the right tool; speak with a professional. Keep this page. The Thought-Capturing Record in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit is a blank version for repeated use, and the 30-day plan will ask you to use it during the third week.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

From False Reassurance to Biblical Truth

Worksheet 14 · Lesson 14

Before you begin. Complete this worksheet during the day, once for one situation. Do not turn the true sentence into a declaration to be repeated until you feel certain. Persistent low mood, hopelessness or difficulty functioning deserves assessment by a doctor rather than another attempt at thinking well.

Use this exercise for one situation at a time. Choose the one you have been reassuring yourself about most.

Step 1. The situation.

Write, in two or three plain sentences, what is actually happening. Include the facts you have been avoiding.

Step 2. The reassurances.

Write the sentences you have been saying to yourself, or that others have said to you, to make it feel better. Write them exactly.

Step 3. Test each one.

Beside each reassurance, answer: Is it true? Is it the whole truth? Has God actually said this? Mark each true, unsupported, or partly true.

Step 4. The true sentence.

For each reassurance that failed, write a sentence that is true instead. Make it honest about what you do not know, honest about what may be lost, and anchored in what God has actually promised to all who are his. If you are not sure whether a promise applies to you, consult the passage in context and, if necessary, ask one appropriately informed pastor or Bible teacher. Do not continue asking different people solely in search of a more comforting interpretation.

Step 5. What the truth permits.

Write one or two things the true sentences now allow you to do that the reassurances did not: a conversation, a plan, a look at the accounts, a prayer that says what is the case.

Step 6. What I will say when the fear returns.

Choose one true sentence from Step 4 and write it on its own line. This is what you will say, not louder, but plainly, when the situation comes to mind.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per situation. When the fear returns, reread Step 6 rather than redoing the test. Do not turn the true sentence into a new declaration to be repeated until you feel certain; its value is that it is true, not that it produces a feeling. If you cannot find any true sentence that you can live in, that is worth bringing to a pastor or counsellor rather than working at alone. Keep this page. The Thought-Capturing Record from Lesson 13 and this exercise work together, and Lesson 15 will give you a fuller test for what counts as true.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

The Philippians 4:8 Pastoral Attention Test

Worksheet 15 · Lesson 15

Before you begin. Use this for what you are deliberately dwelling on, not for every passing thought. Complete it once for one thought or source, during the day. If scrolling or monitoring feels difficult to control or disrupts sleep, or if what you keep returning to comes with vivid images or nightmares, that deserves assessment by a qualified professional.

Use this exercise for one thought, subject or source at a time. Begin with whatever has been occupying your mind most this week. Remember that the six questions are a pastoral tool drawn from the passage, not a translation of it.

Step 1. What I have been dwelling on.

Write it in a sentence. If it is a source—a feed, a site, a programme, a person’s commentary—name it. If it is a thought you generate, write it as Lesson 13 taught you.

Step 2. Run the six questions.

Answer each briefly, and be honest.

Established. Fact, interpretation, prediction or opinion?

Proportionate. Does it represent the wider picture fairly? What has been left out?

Worthy. Is the content honourable, just, pure and commendable, or contemptuous, degrading or built to provoke?

Relevant. Does sustained attention serve a responsibility, a person or a faithful action?

Theologically honest. Have I attached an unsupported claim about God? Test it once, in context.

Bounded. How much attention does this genuinely deserve?

Step 3. The verdict.

Write one of the following and a sentence explaining why.

Keep and dwell. It is established, proportionate, worthy and relevant; it deserves my attention even if it is hard, within the bounds of Step 2.

Know and set down. It is true but offers no faithful response, or deserves far less attention than I have given it; I will note it and turn away.

Decline. It fails at established or worthy, or its presentation is built around alarm; I will stop feeding on it.

Step 4. What I will give my attention to instead.

Write one true and worthy thing you will deliberately dwell on in the time or space this has been occupying: a passage of Scripture, a person, a task, a genuine good in your day.

Step 5. The practical change.

If this was a source, write what you will do differently: a time limit, a substitution, a removal, a reliable source in place of many. If the subject needs expertise—financial, medical, legal—write who the appropriate professional is. Keep the change specific and small enough to keep.

Once is enough. Complete this exercise once per thought or source. Do not run the six questions on every passing thought; that becomes the monitoring Lesson 13 warned against. Use the test for what you are

deliberately dwelling on, and when a declined thought or source pulls at you again, reread Step 3 and turn to Step 4 rather than re-examining it. Keep this page. The Personal Digital Boundary worksheet in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit builds on Step 5, and the 30-day plan will ask you to use this worksheet in the fourth week.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Pray and Release

Prayer that comes to rest, and giving tomorrow back. Lessons 16–17.

The Six-Movement Prayer

Worksheet 16 · Lesson 16

Before you begin. This exercise sets no limit on how often you pray; persistent prayer and honest lament are not unbelief. Do not repeat the sequence solely to neutralise fear, obtain certainty or make the prayer feel correct. If you feel compelled to repeat words or movements until they feel right, stop using it and speak with a professional familiar with OCD or scrupulosity.

Use this exercise for one matter at a time: the one your prayers have been circling. Write it out the first time; afterwards you may pray it in your head.

Movement 1. Become present.

Pause. Write one sentence about where you are and to whom you are speaking.

Movement 2. Name the reality.

In one or two sentences, what is actually known? Not what might happen. What is.

Movement 3. Pour out your heart.

What do I feel about it—fear, grief, anger, desire? Write it honestly and without tidying.

Movement 4. Make your request.

Write your requests, specifically, and add a line expressing openness to God's will. If you find yourself writing the same request again within this prayer to make it feel complete, move to Movement 5.

Movement 5. Remember and discern.

Sit still for a minute or two. Write one or two things that are true about God and bear on this matter, or a verse that comes to mind; write what he has said, not what you hope he will say. Then write what is mine to do today, if anything: act, wait, seek help, or surrender.

Movement 6. Entrust the outcome.

Write a short prayer, in your own words, placing what you cannot control into God's care. Then close the page and do what Movement 5 says.

Do not turn this structure into a rule. This exercise is not governed by a required number. You may return to the same request as often as faithful prayer and honest lament require; persistent prayer is not unbelief. Use the structure when it helps you pray, but do not repeat the sequence solely to neutralise fear, obtain certainty or make the prayer feel correct. If you feel compelled to repeat words or movements until they feel right, stop using the exercise and speak with a professional familiar with OCD or scrupulosity. Keep this page. The Six-Movement Prayer is included in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit, and the 30-day plan will invite you to use it during the third week.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Today, Later or Release?

Worksheet 17 · Lesson 17

Before you begin. Answer the urgency check first: if the tomorrow you have been living in contains credible danger or immediate need — abuse, violence, stalking, imminent homelessness, a symptom that should not wait, a person at risk — that item does not go into any group. Write it at the top of the page and seek safety or qualified help now. Complete the rest during the day, once for one matter; do not begin a full sorting in bed.

Use this for one tomorrow at a time: the one you have been living in most. Write it out the first time. Complete it once for that matter today; if you notice yourself returning to redo it in order to feel certain that the sorting is correct, stop, and use the later list's review time instead.

Step 1. Name the tomorrow.

Write, in one or two plain sentences, the future you have been living in. Include the whole chain if there is one.

Step 2. Check for urgency.

Does this tomorrow contain credible danger or immediate need: abuse, violence, stalking, imminent homelessness, a symptom that should not wait, a person at risk? If so, write it at the top of the page under Urgent, and write the safety step or the qualified help you will seek now. Do not continue sorting until that is written.

Safeguarding exception. If the feared future concerns abuse, violence, stalking, homelessness or another credible danger, do not place it under "release" merely because the worst outcome has not yet happened. Safety planning is present action and should involve appropriate professional support: a domestic-abuse service, the police, a housing or social service, a doctor. The rest of this exercise is for worry that outruns the evidence, not for danger the evidence supports.

Step 3. Test it.

Take the four questions from Lesson 6 in turn and answer each in writing.

What am I predicting? Break the chain into its separate links.

What evidence supports or challenges each link? Mark each one: established, probable, possible, or resting on an earlier link. Remember that "not yet established" is not the same as "false."

What is happening now?

What does the present require, if anything?

Step 4. List what you have been carrying.

Write down each thing you have found yourself doing, deciding, feeling or rehearsing in that tomorrow. One line each.

Step 5. Sort each item.

Beside each line, write today, later or release for now.

Today: a real responsibility that exists now. Write the action or the help to be sought.

Later: will need action, but not yet. Write the trigger: the date, result, decision or piece of information that makes it today's business.

Release for now: not presently actionable. Write briefly why no action is appropriate now: insufficient evidence, dependence on an earlier event that has not happened, no responsibility of mine, or an outcome beyond my control. Writing the reason keeps release from becoming dismissal.

Check the sorting once, honestly: is anything under “later” really today’s, moved there because it is frightening? Is anything under “release” really “seek help”?

Step 6. Decide the review.

Write when you will look at the later list next. A date, or an event. Not “whenever I think of it.”

Step 7. Give tomorrow back.

Write a short prayer, in your own words, handing over what has been released and whatever else remains of that tomorrow. Then close the page and return to the day.

If your tomorrow is a real and present hardship, such as money that will not stretch, housing that is not secure, or a situation in which you are not safe, the “urgent” and “today” columns may be long and their actions may need other people. That is not a failure of the exercise or of your faith. It is the exercise doing what it is for: showing you what needs help now, so that you can seek it. Please do. And if the sorting is done and you still feel anxious, that does not mean it was done wrongly. Keep this page. The Today, Later or Release worksheet is in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit, and the 30-day plan will return to it in the third week, alongside the Six-Movement Prayer.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Control, Influence or Surrender

Worksheet 24 · general

A short version of the sorting that runs through the course, for a matter with many moving parts.

The matter:

Control (what is mine to decide or do, now or at a named time):

Influence (what I can contribute to but not decide: a conversation I can have, help I can offer, an appropriate question I can ask, a referral I can make):

Surrender (what is neither mine to decide nor mine to influence, and belongs to God or to someone else):

Safety (anything here that involves credible danger, which comes before all of the above):

One thing from “control” to do today:

This sheet maps onto the course’s five responses: control is act or wait for a defined reason; influence is share, offer, ask appropriately, or seek qualified help; surrender is release. Do not put under “surrender” what actually belongs under “seek help” or “safety.”

Make Faithful Decisions

When discernment is finished, and what you are waiting to know. Lessons 18–19.

The Faithful Decision Sheet

Worksheet 18 · Lesson 18 · PRIVATE, NOT FOR GROUP SHARING

PRIVATE — NOT FOR GROUP SHARING. This sheet is yours. It is not monitored, included in analytics or shown in ordinary administrator completion views, and you can edit or delete it. You are not required to disclose it to a group leader, pastor, spouse or other participant; you may discuss the relevant facts with an adviser without showing the page. **Safety first.** If the decision concerns a relationship in which you are harmed, controlled or threatened, stop the ordinary exercise and contact a specialist domestic-abuse service from a safe device or place. Moving to safety means following an individual safety plan; it does not necessarily mean leaving, confronting the person or announcing your decision, and do not announce a plan if that could increase danger. If danger is immediate, contact emergency services now. Decisions with serious medical, legal, financial or immigration consequences need qualified advice. Complete this sheet once, for one decision, during the day, at a time when you think clearly. Stop if distress rises. Do not redo it to obtain certainty.

Use this for one decision at a time, the one that has been waiting longest. Write it out. Complete it once; if you find yourself returning to redo it because the answer did not bring the feeling you wanted, stop, and read the “Practical Application” section again instead.

Question 1. What decision is actually before me?

One sentence, with a yes or a no in it, or with named options. Write separately any neighbouring decisions that can wait until this one is made.

Question 2. Is any option morally or legally impermissible?

For each option: does Scripture clearly prohibit or require it? Are there ethical obligations, promises, laws, professional duties or effects on vulnerable people that must be considered? If an option is ruled out, cross it off. If the interpretation is disputed, write the dispute down; do not declare it settled. If nothing is ruled out, write: These are morally permissible options. This is a matter of wisdom.

Question 3. What facts and relevant expertise do I have?

List what is established, what is probable, what has been said and by whom, and what competence you and others bring. Note any field in which you are not qualified.

Question 4. What important information remains obtainable?

Is anything genuinely missing that would change this decision, and can it be obtained within a reasonable time? If yes, write how, and pause the sheet until you have it. If no, write: I have what I need.

Question 5. Who is affected, and who has a legitimate voice?

For each option, write who will be materially affected. Then write who has a legitimate say because of a commitment you have made to them, and whether they have been consulted or only informed.

Question 6. What has relevant counsel said?

For each person consulted, write what they actually said. Note agreement, disagreement, and gaps. Note whether the subject needs a qualified adviser you have not yet consulted. If you are tempted to ask someone new, write why.

Question 7. What do I desire, and what do I fear?

Write what you want, honestly, and what the wanting tells you about yourself; not whether God has authorised it, but what it reveals. Note whether the relief you feel at one option might be wisdom, exhaustion, avoidance or passing emotion. Write what you fear, and briefly what it would mean to you if it happened. One

or two lines; do not keep digging.

Question 8. What will each option require, risk and close?

For each option: what it will demand afterwards, what could go wrong, what ongoing commitments follow, and what it closes.

Question 9. How reversible is it?

For each option, write whether it can be revisited later, and how easily. Mark any option that is difficult or impossible to reverse.

Question 10. What is actually preventing a decision?

Write the honest answer or answers: missing information, courage, a particular person's reaction, a feeling of certainty or peace, wanting someone else to decide, a sign, grief, fear of being wrong, outside pressure, something else.

My faithful response.

Circle one and complete it.

Act: I will _____ by _____ (date). If it is safe and appropriate, I will tell _____.

Wait for a defined reason: I will decide when _____ happens, expected around _____, and I will review on _____.

Seek qualified help: I will ask _____ about _____ this week.

Move to safety: I will contact _____ (emergency or specialist service) and will not announce a plan until I have their advice.

Surrender: This decision or its outcome belongs to _____, and I release it.

If the response is act and the decision is major or difficult to reverse, seek the kind of review the subject requires before doing anything: the relevant person or professional, bounded, competent, and not repeated in search of certainty. Then decide. Keep this page. The Faithful Decision Sheet is in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit, and the 30-day plan offers it as an optional exercise in the fourth week.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

What Am I Waiting to Know Before I Permit Myself to Rest?

Worksheet 19 · Lesson 19

Before you begin. This exercise is not the response to danger: if the wait concerns someone's safety, or yours, present action and qualified help come first. Nothing here asks you to give up necessary monitoring or care — write it down instead, so that release is never confused with neglect. Complete it once for one wait, during the day. If you find yourself redoing it in order to feel certain that the settled column is really settled, stop and read the column instead. And if the wait has broken your rest and the anxiety is severe, persistent or affecting your ability to function, tell your doctor or the clinical team.

Use this for one wait at a time, the one that has most governed your rest. Write it out. Complete it once for that wait; if you find yourself redoing it in order to feel certain that the settled column is really settled, stop, and simply read the column instead.

Step 1. The sentence.

Complete it exactly: I will permit myself peace when I know that _____. Include the part that seems unreasonable on paper.

Step 2. The answer, and what is mine.

Is this answer due? If so, when? If it may never come, write that. Then write two short lists. Necessary: any monitoring, appointment, symptom to report, communication or safety responsibility that the relevant professionals have recommended or that responsibly affects care or preparedness. Not necessary: the watching that produces no information or action. Beside the second list write: This particular watching is not a necessary task. Keep the first list somewhere you can see it, so that release is never confused with neglect.

Step 3. The horizon test.

If this answer came, and came well, what would be the next “when I know”? Write it. If each answer would create another condition, note that you may also be waiting for complete certainty or permanent safety, which no answer supplies.

Step 4. Unresolved and settled.

Write two short lists. What I do not know: the open questions, honestly. What is settled: what is actually established in my circumstances, and what Christ has given me that no outcome changes. Do not put hopes in the second list; put only what is true now.

Step 5. What I have suspended.

Write what you have stopped doing until the answer comes. Beside each, write whether the change is necessary for now, or a result of anxious vigilance. Choose one safe, realistic part of ordinary life to resume or adapt this week, and write when.

Step 6. Coming to Christ.

Write one practice that directs your attention toward Christ rather than toward the answer, and when you will do it this week. Then write a short prayer, in your own words, coming to him before you know, and asking still for what you hope. You do not need to feel anything in particular while writing it.

If the wait concerns danger, yours or someone else's, this exercise is not the response; present action and qualified help are. And if your rest has been broken by a wait you cannot shorten, and the anxiety is severe, persistent or affecting your ability to function, tell your doctor or the clinical team. Peace before answers is a gift to be received; it is not a reason to go without help. Keep this page. This worksheet is in the Course Journal

and Practical Toolkit, and the 30-day plan will return to it in the fourth week.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Build a Quieter Rhythm

A rule of life, the boundaries that protect it, and the people who hold it. Lesson 20.

My Peace-Supporting Weekly Rhythm

Worksheet 20 · Lesson 20

Before you begin. Acute crisis is not the time for an ambitious new rule: keep only what is necessary for safety and basic functioning, and come back to this later. Write it once, for the season you are in, during the day. If you find yourself rewriting it repeatedly in order to get it right, stop, keep the version you have, and review it at the date you set. If the rule becomes rigid — if missing an item produces disproportionate distress, or items must be completed in a particular way or order for the day to feel safe — stop using it and speak with a qualified professional. Medication is never changed because of anything on this page.

Use this to write a rule of life for the season you are in. Write it out. Do it once, in ordinary time; if you are in acute crisis, keep only what is necessary for safety and basic functioning, and come back to the rest later. If you find yourself rewriting the rule repeatedly in order to get it right, stop, keep whatever version you have, and review it at the date you set rather than now.

Step 1. My actual week.

Write, honestly, what an ordinary week currently contains. Do not write what you intend; write what happens.

When I pray:

When I read Scripture:

When I sleep, and how:

When my work ends, and where my phone is in the evening:

When I move my body:

Whom I see, and when:

When I rest:

What Christian community I am part of, and how:

What professional support I have, if any:

Step 2. My rule for this season.

Write one line for each. Tie each to a time, a place or a reliable cue. Keep them small enough to survive a bad week.

One practice that turns me toward God:

One practice that supports my body (sleep, movement or rest):

One boundary that protects my attention or my rest:

One form of safe relationship or support, including professional care if I need it:

Step 3. The grace clause.

Beside each line, write what I will do when I miss it.

Step 4. Where the tools live.

Write when and where, during waking hours, I will use the practices from this course that have helped me most: the Thought-Capturing Record, the Six-Movement Prayer, the later list, or another. Note that night-time gets only the brief note, never the full exercise.

Step 5. What support, if any, would help?

If there is a safe and trustworthy person, write which lines of this rule I would like their support with, and when I will ask. Write only what I am comfortable sharing. If there is no such person yet, write the first name on my Support Map.

Step 6. Review.

Write the date, about a month from now, when I will look at this again and adjust it. Write also the season this rule is for, so that when the season changes I rewrite it rather than carry it as a reproach.

If this rule becomes rigid—if missing an item produces disproportionate distress, or you must complete items in a particular way or order for the day to feel safe—stop using it and speak with a qualified professional, who can help assess

what is happening. A rule of life is a trellis, not a ritual, and a trellis that has started to strangle the plant is not doing its work. Medication, if you take it, is never changed because of anything on this page. Keep this page. The weekly rhythm worksheet is in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit, and the 30-day plan will invite you to write your rule in its final days.

Complete this once for one matter, then stop. If you find yourself redoing it to feel certain the answer is right, that is a signal to put it down, not to try again. This worksheet does not treat an anxiety disorder, depression, OCD or trauma; if a professional is supporting you, their guidance takes priority.

Personal Digital Boundary

Worksheet 26 · Lesson 20

Written by me, for my life. No prescribed limits.

When my work day ends, and what I will do to mark it:

Where my phone lives in the evening (allowing for anyone who may need to reach me: medical, caregiving, emergency):

What I check last thing at night, and whether it helps me sleep:

What I will check before bed instead, or nothing:

One feed, thread or app that the attention test would set down or decline, and what I will do about it:

The one boundary I can keep this week:

Adapt phone boundaries around accessibility, medical, caregiving and safety needs. A carer or a patient may need the phone within reach, and that is not a failure of the rule.

Support Map

Worksheet 27 · Lesson 20

For arranging support before it is needed. Disclosure is optional and only ever to safe people.

People who support me, listen wisely, share appropriate burdens, or help me reach professional care:

The person I could speak to this week, and what, if anything, I would be comfortable telling them:

Professionals I have (doctor, counsellor, therapist, psychiatrist, other), and how to contact them:

Professionals I may need, and how I would begin to find them (primary-care clinician, recognised health service, reputable community organisation):

The Christian community available and safe for me, and in what form:

People I have been contacting only in crisis:

You are never required to disclose anything you are not comfortable sharing, and you should not share medical information or anything that could expose you to control or judgement. Finding Help Where You Live shows how to find services in your country.

For the Night

The one page for the middle of the night. Nothing else until morning.

Night-Time Thought Download

Worksheet 25 · general, for the night

For when a concern arrives in the dark. A brief note only. Do not begin a full worksheet in bed.

What is on my mind: one brief line for each concern that is already demanding your attention; no sorting, no analysis. Do not try to make the list complete.

When I will look at this: tomorrow during my next waking period / at a specific time I have chosen.

A short prayer of handing over, if I can:

If writing increases alertness, or you find yourself getting up to check that the note is complete, leave this sheet for daytime. If sleep does not come, that is not failure; if sleep has been persistently poor, speak with a healthcare professional.

The 30-Day Mind-Renewal Journey

The thirty day pages as published, and the optional tracker. Each day is marked Worksheet, Brief, Action, Ordinary or Rest.

The Thirty Days

The 30-Day Mind-Renewal Journey, as published. Each day is marked Worksheet, Brief, Action, Ordinary or Rest.

Days do not have to be consecutive. Thirty days may take six weeks or longer, and that is still the journey. If you miss a day, do the next one; do not go back and catch up, and do not restart from Day 1. A missed day is a day.

Week One: Notice

Day 1: What has been occupying my mind **Worksheet**

“When the cares of my heart are many, your consolations cheer my soul.”

Focus. Lesson 1. Before anything can be tested or released, it has to be seen.

Practice. Complete “What Has Been Occupying My Mind?” from Lesson 1. Write down, without editing, the things your mind has returned to most in the past week. Do not sort them yet.

Prompt. Which of these surprised me by being on the list?

Day 2: Thinking or circling **Brief**

“For everything there is a season... a time to keep silence, and a time to speak.”

Focus. Lesson 2. Not all repeated thinking is overthinking. Some of it is planning, discernment or problem-solving.

Practice. Choose one item from Day 1 that returned frequently and run it through the five questions of “Healthy Thinking or Mental Circling?” Leave the other items for later chapters or for professional discussion.

Prompt. If this was circling, what was the thinking hoping to achieve that it could not?

Day 3: What I have told myself about my faith **Worksheet**

“When I am afraid, I put my trust in you.”

Focus. Lesson 3. Fear is an experience. Trust is a direction. The two can travel together.

Practice. Complete “What Have I Been Telling Myself About My Faith?” Write the sentences you have believed about what your anxiety says about you as a Christian, and beside each, what Lesson 3 said instead.

Prompt. Do I already know where the most damaging sentence came from? If not, I do not need to search for an origin.

Day 4: One act of care for the body **Ordinary**

“Arise and eat, for the journey is too great for you.”

Focus. Lesson 5. Sleep loss, illness, physical discomfort, irregular meals, stress or stimulants may contribute to a restless mind. They do not explain every case, but they are part of the story.

Practice. No writing today. Do one ordinary thing for your body that you have been putting off: a proper meal, a walk, an earlier bedtime, a glass of water in the afternoon instead of another coffee. Nothing to analyse.

Prompt. None. Let the day be the practice.

Day 5: The fear beneath the thought **Brief, optional**

“I pour out my complaint before him; I tell my trouble before him.”

Focus. Lesson 4. Sometimes the surface thought is not the whole story. Sometimes it is.

Practice. Take one circling item and ask “If this happened, what would it mean to me?” no more than twice. Treat any answer as a possibility to consider, not a diagnosis, a recovered memory or a revelation from God. If no deeper sentence comes, write that; it is a legitimate result. Stop if the exercise increases distress.

Prompt. Does this item need a practical response, a response to a deeper fear, both, or neither?

Day 6: Noticing triggers **Action**

“Search me, O God, and know my heart.”

Focus. Lessons 1-5 together. Ask God for honest awareness while noticing the recurring situations and states in which your mind circles most, without treating every trigger as morally significant.

Practice. Look back over the week and use the toolkit’s “Common Triggers” worksheet lightly: tick what you have noticed (late evening, the phone, a particular person, hunger, an unanswered message, Sunday night). Then take one practical step today about the trigger that is easiest to change.

Prompt. Which trigger cannot be changed and will have to be met differently?

Day 7: Rest and look **Rest**

“Come away by yourselves to a desolate place and rest a while.”

Focus. The first week is done. Nothing has been fixed, and nothing was supposed to be.

Practice. No exercise. Read over the week’s pages once, if you wish. Then do something restful that is not about your mind.

Prompt. One sentence, if one comes: what has this week shown me?

Week Two: Test

Day 8: What am I predicting **Worksheet**

"Sufficient for the day is its own trouble."

Focus. Lesson 6. A prediction is not yet established; it is not the same as a fact.

Practice. Take the matter your mind has predicted worst outcomes for and complete "Possibility, Probability and Present Reality": what am I predicting, what evidence supports or challenges it, what is happening now, what does the present require.

Prompt. Where in the chain did the evidence run out?

Day 9: Replaying what I cannot change **Brief**

"Forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead."

Focus. Lesson 7. Rumination and repentance are not the same thing.

Practice. Take one past event your mind keeps returning to. Write one line: does it need repair, learning, continuing or release? If repair, note only whether repair is safe and appropriate; do not plan it today. The full "Repair, Learn, Continue or Release" worksheet is in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit for when you have time.

Prompt. Have I been confessing a regret as though it were a sin?

Day 10: Said and imagined **Worksheet**

"If one gives an answer before he hears, it is his folly and shame."

Focus. Lesson 8. Prolonged rehearsal can replace the real person with a version written by fear. Bounded preparation may still be useful.

Practice. Take one conversation you have been rehearsing and complete "What Was Said and What Did I Imagine?" Separate the two columns honestly. Decide: ask, not yet, no, or ask someone else. Keep any written imagined dialogue to ten lines, and stop if it becomes distressing.

Prompt. How much of the conversation that has been troubling me actually happened?

Day 11: Facts and assumptions **Brief**

“Love... believes all things, hopes all things.”

Focus. Lesson 9. An observation is not an interpretation, and one event is not a pattern. Love is not gullibility, though: do not generate charitable explanations to dismiss an established pattern of deception, coercion or harm.

Practice. Take one person whose mind you have been trying to read. Write what you actually observed, stripped of the motive you supplied. Write two other possible explanations, then stop. Decide: ask clearly, seek appropriate clarification, wait with ordinary respect, or let go.

Prompt. Was this a single event or a pattern? What is the evidence for the answer?

Day 12: Information or courage **Brief**

“If any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask God.”

Focus. Lesson 10. James promises that God gives wisdom generously; it does not promise that every decision will be answered by a private sign. Christians understand impressions and signs differently, but none should bypass Scripture, evidence, consent, safety or relevant expertise.

Practice. Take one matter you have been seeking confirmation about. Write which of these is true: I need more information; I need more courage; both; neither, because the decision or outcome is not mine. If information is genuinely missing, write where it can be obtained.

Prompt. How many times have I asked the same question, and what was the asking doing?

Day 13: Faithful, wise or perfect **Action**

“He who observes the wind will not sow.”

Focus. Lesson 11. Flawless certainty and protection from every criticism are not available. Responsible excellence should not be confused with fear-driven perfectionism.

Practice. Choose one low-risk task you have been over-checking or delaying. Do it faithfully, to the standard it actually requires, and stop. No worksheet today. If you have OCD, do not drop any checks abruptly; choose a task your professional would consider appropriate.

Prompt. What did “done faithfully” look like, and what did stopping feel like?

Day 14: Rest and look **Rest**

"But I have calmed and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with its mother."

Focus. Two weeks done. You have noticed, and you have begun to test.

Practice. No exercise. Do something restful. If you use the tracker, glance at it once.

Prompt. One sentence, if one comes: which test this week changed what I believed?

Week Three: Release

Day 15: One thought, examined **Brief**

"Take every thought captive to obey Christ."

Focus. Lesson 13. Second Corinthians 10 concerns arguments opposed to the knowledge of God, not a command to police every private thought; this exercise is a careful pastoral application. It is examination of a claim, and a response, not suppression.

Practice. At one planned time during waking hours, choose one recurring thought that makes a testable claim and use the six movements once: notice, name, test, refuse, reorient, act. Do not monitor your mind through the day looking for a suitable thought.

Prompt. Did the claim survive testing? What did "act" turn out to be?

Day 16: What is mine to carry **Brief**

"Bear one another's burdens... For each will have to bear his own load."

Focus. Lesson 12. Not every need you can see is yours to meet.

Practice. Take one person you have been carrying in your mind. Using the five questions from Lesson 12, write which category they belong in: carry, share, offer, refer or release. Reduce only an unnecessary or unrequested action; do not withdraw from an established responsibility as an experiment.

Prompt. If the answer was "release," what am I releasing, and to whom does it belong?

Day 17: The six-movement prayer **Worksheet**

"Pour out your heart before him; God is a refuge for us."

Focus. Lesson 16. Prayer that has somewhere to go, so that it does not become more worry.

Practice. Pray "The Six-Movement Prayer" in writing for the matter that has most turned your prayers into worry: become present, name the reality, pour out your heart, make your request, remember and discern, entrust the outcome. Then do what movement five said.

Prompt. Which movement did I usually skip before today?

Day 18: From false reassurance to biblical truth **Brief**

"Be transformed by the renewal of your mind."

Focus. Lesson 14. Romans 12 describes the transformation of judgement, desire, conduct and communal life in response to God's mercy. Truthful self-talk is one application of it, not the whole meaning.

Practice. Write one reassurance you have been giving yourself ("it'll be fine," "God won't let that happen"). Beside it, write what Scripture actually says, in context. One pair only; the full worksheet is in the Course Journal and Practical Toolkit.

Prompt. Is what God has actually said harder or easier to rest on than what I had been telling myself?

Day 19: Today, later or release **Worksheet**

"Seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness."

Focus. Lesson 17. Preparing for tomorrow is wisdom. Living in it before it arrives is not.

Practice. Complete "Today, Later or Release?" for the tomorrow you have been living in most. Check first for anything urgent. Then sort: today, later with a trigger, or release for now with a written reason. Set a review date for the later list.

Prompt. Which item have I been treating as actionable even though no responsible action is currently available?

Day 20: Set one thing down **Action**

"Whatever is true... think about these things."

Focus. Lesson 15. Not everything true deserves dwelling. The six questions of the Philippians 4:8 Pastoral Attention Test are an applied framework, not translations of Paul's eight descriptions.

Practice. No worksheet. Choose one thing you have been dwelling on that the attention test would place under "know and set down" or "decline": a news thread, a comparison, an old grievance, a feed. Take one practical step today to stop feeding it. Then do the "today" item from Day 19, if there was one.

Prompt. What did I do instead with the attention I set down?

Day 21: Rest and look **Rest**

"Be still, and know that I am God."

Focus. Three weeks done. You have noticed, tested and begun to release.

Practice. No exercise. Do something restful. If any exercise this week became something you kept redoing to feel certain, make a note of it for Day 29, and leave it there.

Prompt. One sentence, if one comes: what have I been able to release, and what still feels difficult to carry? Neither answer is a failure.

Week Four: Practise

Day 22: Peace before answers **Worksheet**

"Peace I leave with you; my peace I give to you."

Focus. Lesson 19. Christ gave peace to his disciples before their answers came. He has not made yours conditional on knowing.

Practice. Complete "What Am I Waiting to Know Before I Permit Myself to Rest?" Write the sentence, separate necessary monitoring from anxious watching, and choose one suspended thing to resume or adapt this week.

Prompt. If the answer I am waiting for came, what would I then be waiting to know?

Day 23: The six-movement prayer, again **Brief**

“For God alone my soul waits in silence.”

Focus. Lesson 16. Repetition is not unbelief. The shape is there to help prayer rest, not to limit it.

Practice. Pray the six movements, in your head or on paper, for a different matter from Day 17, or return to the same unchanged need as an act of persistent prayer or lament. Stop only if you notice that you are repeating the structure to neutralise fear, to obtain certainty, or to make the prayer feel correct.

Prompt. Was today’s prayer persistence, lament, intercession, or an attempt to neutralise fear?

Day 24: A digital boundary **Action**

“Look carefully then how you walk... making the best use of the time.”

Focus. Lessons 15 and 20. Where the phone lives in the evening shapes where the mind lives at night.

Practice. Look at the toolkit’s “Personal Digital Boundary” and choose one boundary you can keep this week: when work ends and how you mark it, where the phone lives in the evening, what you check before bed. Adapt it for anyone who may need to reach you. Put it into practice tonight.

Prompt. What do I check last thing at night, and does it help me sleep?

Day 25: A support map **Brief**

“Two are better than one... For if they fall, one will lift up his fellow.”

Focus. Lessons 12 and 20. A restless mind isolates. Support should be arranged before it is needed.

Practice. Sketch the toolkit’s “Support Map”: the people who support you, listen wisely, share appropriate burdens or help you reach professional care; the professionals you have or may need; the Christian community available to you. If there is a safe person on it, mark what, if anything, you would be comfortable telling them this week. Disclosure is optional and only ever to safe people.

Prompt. Who on this map have I been contacting only in crisis?

Day 26: My actual week **Worksheet**

“He departed and went out to a desolate place, and there he prayed.”

Focus. Lesson 20. Before writing a rule, see the week you actually have.

Practice. Complete Step 1 of “My Peace-Supporting Weekly Rhythm”: the honest week. Write what happens, not what you intend.

Prompt. Where in this week does the mind start from exhaustion and a screen?

Day 27: My rule for this season **Worksheet**

“He would withdraw to desolate places and pray.”

Focus. Lesson 20. A trellis, not a law.

Practice. Complete the rest of “My Peace-Supporting Weekly Rhythm”: one practice toward God, one for the body, one boundary, one form of support, the grace clause, and a review date. Tie each to a time, a place or a reliable cue; shift workers, carers and people with fluctuating health do not need a fixed clock time. Keep it to half a page.

Prompt. Could I keep this in a week when everything else went wrong?

Day 28: Do one thing **Rest**

“He gives to his beloved sleep.” This verse presents rest as gift rather than achievement, and translators differ on whether God gives sleep to his beloved or gives to them while they sleep. It is not a promise that completing today’s practice will make sleep come.

Focus. The rule begins.

Practice. Do one line of your rule today, at its cue, and then rest. If it is your day of rest, let this be the rest.

Prompt. One sentence, if one comes: what did I do today, and what did I let be?

Review and Commitment

Day 29: Review Brief

"His mercies... are new every morning."

Focus. Look at the month as a whole, kindly.

Practice. Read back over the month, using the tracker if you kept one. Write three short lists. What helped: the practices that gave your mind somewhere to go. What did not: the practices that were not for you, or not for this season; leave them without guilt. What became difficult: any exercise you kept redoing to feel certain, or any routine that produced distress when missed. Then complete the toolkit's "When I Need Additional Help" worksheet honestly.

Prompt. Did this month show me that I need more than this course? If so, what is the next step, and who will I contact? > **Note.** If a practice repeatedly became compulsory, produced significant distress, interfered with daily functioning, or felt impossible to stop, contact a qualified mental-health professional. A single uncomfortable or overextended exercise does not diagnose a condition. And if the help notes spoke to you throughout the month, please treat the "When I Need Additional Help" worksheet as the most important page of the plan. Contacting a doctor, a qualified professional or another appropriate service is not a failure of the thirty days. For some readers, it is what the thirty days were for.

Day 30: Commitment Brief

"He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ."

Focus. Not a finish line. A beginning.

Practice. From the "what helped" list, choose two or three practices to carry forward, and write where they live in your rule. Then pray the Final Prayer of Surrender, which is on this page below, or, if you are uncertain about belonging to Christ, pray only what you can say honestly and turn to the Start Here page "If You Are Not Sure You Belong to Christ".

Prompt. One sentence, to be read in a month: what do I want to remember from these thirty days when my mind will not rest?

30-Day Tracker

Worksheet 29 · the 30-day journey · optional

One line per day: the date, and a word or two. Nothing else.

Use it only if it helps you see the month without scoring yourself. If you find yourself repeatedly checking, correcting or analysing it, stop using it.

Day	Date	A word or two
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		
21		
22		
23		
24		
25		
26		
27		
28		
29		
30		

This page is never scored, and the course does not read it.

Emergency and Support Pages

Keep these two pages where you can find them. They are the most important pages in this toolkit.

Get Help Now

Emergency and support page · contact information last checked 15 September 2026. Services, hours and numbers can change.

If you are in immediate danger, or you may act on thoughts of ending your life, use your country's emergency number now. 112 in most of Europe · 911 in the United States and Canada · 999 in the United Kingdom · 000 in Australia · in Thailand, 1669 for a medical emergency and 191 for the police.

If you do not know your country's number, go to the nearest emergency department, or ask a trusted person nearby to help you contact the appropriate local emergency or crisis service. Contact police when police assistance is needed and it is safe to do so.

To find a crisis line for your country tonight: Find A Helpline (findahelpline.com) provides verified helpline information for more than 150 countries, by phone, text and online chat. The International Association for Suicide Prevention (iasp.info) also directs people seeking crisis support to Find A Helpline. Availability and hours vary by country.

Other directories: Befrienders Worldwide (befrienders.org) · Child Helpline International (childhelplineinternational.org) · Lila.help, for domestic abuse (lila.help).

Some examples, correct when checked. Thailand: medical emergency 1669; police 191; Department of Mental Health hotline 1323; Social Help Centre 1300; Samaritans Thailand 02 113 6789, press 2 for the English callback service, which is not a substitute for emergency assistance. United Kingdom and Republic of Ireland: Samaritans 116 123, free day or night. United States: call or text 988. Canada: call or text 9-8-8. Australia: Lifeline 13 11 14. New Zealand: call or text 1737.

To find ongoing care, the usual first step is a primary-care doctor, who can assess what is happening, consider whether physical factors may be contributing, discuss appropriate care and make a referral where necessary. Ask what is free or subsidised, what can be done by telephone or video, and whether a church or charity near you can help you reach it.

A word about your church. A pastor can be one of the best people to help you find and reach professional help. But pastoral care is not clinical treatment and should not be asked to take its place.

This course does not monitor what you write. Journal entries, reflections and check-ins are not monitored, and writing that you need help does not alert Faithful Path or contact any of these services. If you need a person, contact one of them directly.

When This Course Is Not Enough

Emergency and support page · the short form. The full page is in the course.

Please seek more than this course if any of the following describes you. Doing so is not a failure of faith, and it is not a failure of the course.

- **Thoughts of suicide or self-harm.** Contact appropriate support today, and emergency or crisis services now if you may act, cannot keep yourself safe or are in immediate danger. Do not remain alone.
- **Panic or urgent physical symptoms.** Do not assume that chest pain, severe difficulty breathing, fainting or sudden confusion is anxiety. Seek urgent medical assessment.
- **Severe disruption to daily life,** or sleep problems that are severe, persistent or worsening.
- **Trauma,** or a memory that returns as vivid images, nightmares or a sense of reliving.
- **Abuse, danger or a safeguarding concern,** for you or for someone in your care.
- **Severe or persistent anxiety or low mood.**
- **Pregnancy and the period after birth,** where thoughts are accompanied by an urge to act, or by confusion, hallucinations or loss of contact with reality: this is a medical emergency.
- **Obsessive or compulsive patterns,** including repeated checking, confessing or reassurance-seeking.
- **A course exercise that has become a problem:** compulsory, distressing, or impossible to stop.

If a qualified professional is already supporting you, their guidance takes priority over anything in this course, including the exercises and their limits.

Scripture notice

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible (The Holy Bible, English Standard Version®), © 2001 by Crossway, a publishing ministry of Good News Publishers. ESV Text Edition: 2025. The ESV text may not be quoted in any publication made available to the public by a Creative Commons license. The ESV may not be translated in whole or in part into any other language. Used by permission. All rights reserved.

You do not have to solve your whole life tonight.